

The Australian Government has invested \$40.7 million in a national network of Sustainable Agriculture Facilitators under the Climate-Smart Agriculture Program, funded through the Natural Heritage Trust (NHT).

The facilitators will connect farmers, landholders, community groups and agriculture industries to relevant information and programs on climate-smart, sustainable agriculture practices; facilitate partnerships and connections; and support the delivery of sustainable agriculture projects in their region. This investment builds on the valuable work of the Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator network funded through the previous phase of the NHT.

## **SAF services**

- Engage and inform farmers, landholders, community groups, and agriculture industries within their NRM region about climate-smart, sustainable agriculture practices to help achieve climate-smart sustainable agriculture outcomes. Including best practice natural resource management, biodiversity and carbon markets, and practices that support emission reductions and build climate resilience on-farm.

This may include:

- sharing relevant government information, policies, programs, and tools.
- advising of upcoming funding opportunities.
- sharing relevant training opportunities.
- Facilitate partnerships and connections that will assist farmers, landholders, community groups and agriculture industries to work together to achieve sustainable agriculture outcomes.

This may include connections with:

- other farmers, landholders, community groups or areas of industry (for example where there are areas of alignment, common issues, or solutions that would provide mutual or co-benefits).
- extension officers, including Regional Soil Coordinators, Adoption Officers in the Drought Resilience Adoption and Innovation Hubs, and advisors under the Carbon Farming Outreach Program.
- grantees funded under the Natural Heritage Trust.
- Support the delivery of sustainable agriculture projects in their NRM region.

This may include:

- Assisting with events, communication activities and communities of practice.
- Connecting stakeholders.
- Engaging with First Nations peoples and organisations.

SAFs support the following three Climate-Smart Agriculture Program outcomes:

- The agriculture sector is adopting practices to reduce emissions and build resilience to climate change.
- The agriculture sector is supported to harness carbon and biodiversity incentives and implement industry sustainability frameworks.

- Farmers are supported to drive agricultural growth, while adopting sustainable natural resource management practices that protect and conserve natural capital and biodiversity.

## Find your SAF

To find out how your local SAF may be able to assist you, please see a list of SAF contact details for each NRM region below.

| Name              | Management Unit     | Email address                                                                          | Contact number |
|-------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Jeni Cumberland   | ACT                 | <a href="mailto:jenilee.cumberland@act.gov.au">jenilee.cumberland@act.gov.au</a>       | 0407 321 784   |
| Mary Bonet        | ACT                 | <a href="mailto:mary.bonet@act.gov.au">mary.bonet@act.gov.au</a>                       | 0459 352 892   |
| Lana Andrews      | North West          | <a href="mailto:lane.andrews@lls.nsw.gov.au">lane.andrews@lls.nsw.gov.au</a>           | 0417 328 615   |
| Jade Auldist      | Riverina            | <a href="mailto:jade.auldist@lls.nsw.gov.au">jade.auldist@lls.nsw.gov.au</a>           | 0473 055 466   |
| Liz Davis         | Central Tablelands  | <a href="mailto:liz.davis@lls.nsw.gov.au">liz.davis@lls.nsw.gov.au</a>                 | 0427 452 662   |
| Genevieve Murphy  | North Coast         | <a href="mailto:genevieve.murphy@lls.nsw.gov.au">genevieve.murphy@lls.nsw.gov.au</a>   | 0428 394 948   |
| Eloise Haigh      | Hunter              | <a href="mailto:eloise.haigh@lls.nsw.gov.au">eloise.haigh@lls.nsw.gov.au</a>           | 0438 484 196   |
| Richard Stephens  | Greater Sydney      | <a href="mailto:richard.stephens@lls.nsw.gov.au">richard.stephens@lls.nsw.gov.au</a>   | 0436 803 337   |
| Henry Goodall     | South East          | <a href="mailto:henry.goodall@lls.nsw.gov.au">henry.goodall@lls.nsw.gov.au</a>         | 0438 744 267   |
| Bonnie Mitchell   | Central West        | <a href="mailto:bonnie.mitchell@lls.nsw.gov.au">bonnie.mitchell@lls.nsw.gov.au</a>     | 0455 221 976   |
| Kathleen Bartlett | Murray              | <a href="mailto:kathleen.bartlett@lls.nsw.gov.au">kathleen.bartlett@lls.nsw.gov.au</a> | 0419 839 049   |
| Brianna Carney    | Northern Tablelands | <a href="mailto:brianna.carney@lls.nsw.gov.au">brianna.carney@lls.nsw.gov.au</a>       | 0448 501 980   |
| Christine Plummer | Western             | <a href="mailto:christine.plummer@lls.nsw.gov.au">christine.plummer@lls.nsw.gov.au</a> | 0408 241 200   |

| Name              | Management Unit       | Email address                                                                              | Contact number |
|-------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Claire Thompson   | Burnett Mary          | <a href="mailto:claire.thompson@bmrg.org.au">claire.thompson@bmrg.org.au</a>               | 0439 389 847   |
| Kellie Harmsworth | Mackay Whitsunday     | <a href="mailto:saf@reefcatchments.com">saf@reefcatchments.com</a>                         | 0456 182 348   |
| Lene Knudsen      | South East Queensland | <a href="mailto:lene.k@hlw.org.au">lene.k@hlw.org.au</a>                                   | 0429 000 179   |
| Emily Hedger      | South East Queensland | <a href="mailto:emily.h@hlw.org.au">emily.h@hlw.org.au</a>                                 | 0497 935 488   |
|                   |                       |                                                                                            | 0488 675 033   |
| Peter Arthofer    | Burdekin              | <a href="mailto:peter.arthofer@nqdrytropics.com.au">peter.arthofer@nqdrytropics.com.au</a> | 07 4799 3500   |
| Lauren O'Bryan    | Cape York             | <a href="mailto:lauren.obryan@capeyorknrm.com.au">lauren.obryan@capeyorknrm.com.au</a>     | 0477 720 359   |
| Tom Crow          | Wet Tropics           | <a href="mailto:tom.crow@terrain.org.au">tom.crow@terrain.org.au</a>                       | 0468 365 840   |
| Sheree Johnston   | Fitzroy               | <a href="mailto:sheree.johnston@fba.org.au">sheree.johnston@fba.org.au</a>                 | 0448 219 982   |
| Doug Allpass      | Desert Channels       | <a href="mailto:doug.allpass@dcq.org.au">doug.allpass@dcq.org.au</a>                       | 07 4652 7814   |

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|------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Mandy Pickering  | Northern Gulf       | <a href="mailto:mandy.pickering@gulfsavannahnm.org">mandy.pickering@gulfsavannahnm.org</a>     | 0429 672 058 |
| Emily Turner     | Southern Gulf       | <a href="mailto:emily.turner@southerngulf.com.au">emily.turner@southerngulf.com.au</a>         | 0436 623 696 |
| Caroline Webster | Southern Queensland | <a href="mailto:caroline.webster@sqlandscapes.org.au">caroline.webster@sqlandscapes.org.au</a> | 0436 929 028 |

| Name | Management Unit | Email address | Contact number |
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|--------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Lucy Bullock | Northern Territory | <a href="mailto:lucy.bullock@territorynrm.org.au">lucy.bullock@territorynrm.org.au</a> | 0477 100 117 |
|--------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|

| Name            | Management Unit                    | Email address                                                                  | Contact number |
|-----------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Chloe Smart     | South Australian Arid Lands        | <a href="mailto:andrea.tschirner@sa.gov.au">andrea.tschirner@sa.gov.au</a>     | 0438 720 469   |
| Amy Wright      | Eyre Peninsula                     | <a href="mailto:amy.wright@airep.com.au">amy.wright@airep.com.au</a>           | 0467 004 555   |
| Joaquin Pillado | Kangaroo Island                    | <a href="mailto:joaquin.pillado@sa.gov.au">joaquin.pillado@sa.gov.au</a>       | 0437 172 877   |
|                 |                                    |                                                                                | (08) 8532 9100 |
| Jeremy Nelson   | Murraylands and Riverland          | <a href="mailto:jeremy.nelson@sa.gov.au">jeremy.nelson@sa.gov.au</a>           | 0439 591 826   |
| Barrie Williams | Murraylands and Riverland          | <a href="mailto:barrie.williams@sa.gov.au">barrie.williams@sa.gov.au</a>       | 0427 834 396   |
| Molly O'Dea     | Northern and Yorke                 | <a href="mailto:molly.o'dea@sa.gov.au">molly.o'dea@sa.gov.au</a>               | 0456 538 224   |
| Michael Clinch  | Alinytjara Wilurara                | <a href="mailto:michael.clinch@anangu.com.au">michael.clinch@anangu.com.au</a> | 0427 070 097   |
| Ash Walker      | Alinytjara Wilurara                | <a href="mailto:ashley.walker@sa.gov.au">ashley.walker@sa.gov.au</a>           | 0488 148 487   |
|                 |                                    |                                                                                | (08) 8391 7500 |
| Donna Bartsch   | Hills and Fleurieu Landscape Board | <a href="mailto:donna.bartsch@sa.gov.au">donna.bartsch@sa.gov.au</a>           | 0456 047 526   |
| Michael Brown   | Limestone Coast                    | <a href="mailto:michael.brown4@sa.gov.au">michael.brown4@sa.gov.au</a>         | 0497 646 629   |

| Name | Management Unit | Email address | Contact number |
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|------|-----------------|---------------|----------------|

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|----------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Dr Adeel Afzal | North NRM      | <a href="mailto:gmartinaafzal@nrmnorth.org.au">gmartinaafzal@nrmnorth.org.au</a> | 03 6333 7791   |
| Sushma Banala  | North NRM      | <a href="mailto:sbanala@nrmnorth.org.au">sbanala@nrmnorth.org.au</a>             | 03 6333 7791   |
|                |                |                                                                                  | (03) 6433 8440 |
| Tom O'Malley   | North West NRM | <a href="mailto:tomalley@cradlecoast.com">tomalley@cradlecoast.com</a>           | 0410 150 994   |
| Tim Ackroyd    | South NRM      | <a href="mailto:tackroyd@nrmsouth.org.au">tackroyd@nrmsouth.org.au</a>           | 0400 047 665   |
| Jacinta Leys   | South NRM      | <a href="mailto:jleys@nrmsouth.org.au">jleys@nrmsouth.org.au</a>                 | TBA            |

| Name        | Management Unit | Email address                                                                  | Contact number |
|-------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
|             |                 |                                                                                | 0400 467 921   |
| Emma Orgill | East Gippsland  | <a href="mailto:emma.orgill@fevl.org.au">emma.orgill@fevl.org.au</a>           | (03) 5154 2867 |
| Darren Bain | North Central   | <a href="mailto:darren.bain@nccma.vic.gov.au">darren.bain@nccma.vic.gov.au</a> | 0419 560 348   |

| Bronwyn Bant      | Wimmera                      | <a href="mailto:bronwyn.bant@wcma.vic.gov.au">bronwyn.bant@wcma.vic.gov.au</a>             | 0427 529 232                   |
|-------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| David Brunton     | Wimmera                      | <a href="mailto:david.brunton@wcma.vic.gov.au">david.brunton@wcma.vic.gov.au</a>           | 0439 978 133                   |
| Cameron Flowers   | Mallee                       | <a href="mailto:cameron.flowers@malleecma.com.au">cameron.flowers@malleecma.com.au</a>     | 0427 509 663                   |
| Sam Shannon       | West Gippsland               | <a href="mailto:sams@wgcm.vic.gov.au">sams@wgcm.vic.gov.au</a>                             | 0409 944 114                   |
| Mary Knight       | Glenelg Hopkins              | <a href="mailto:m.knight@ghcma.vic.gov.au">m.knight@ghcma.vic.gov.au</a>                   | 0417 513 724                   |
| Lachlan Campbell  | North East                   | <a href="mailto:lachlan.campbell@necma.vic.gov.au">lachlan.campbell@necma.vic.gov.au</a>   | 0400 852 482<br>(02) 6043 7672 |
| Karen O'Keefe     | Corangamite                  | <a href="mailto:karen.okeefe@ccma.vic.gov.au">karen.okeefe@ccma.vic.gov.au</a>             | 0409 559 482<br>1800 002 262   |
| Karen Thomas      | Port Phillip & Westernport   | <a href="mailto:karen.thomas@melbournewater.com.au">karen.thomas@melbournewater.com.au</a> | 0427 480 170                   |
| Rhiannon Sandford | Goulburn Broken              | <a href="mailto:rhiannons@gbcm.vic.gov.au">rhiannons@gbcm.vic.gov.au</a>                   | 0429 964 609                   |
| Name              | Management Unit              | Email address                                                                              | Contact number                 |
| Jacquie Lucas     | Avon River Basin             | <a href="mailto:jlucas@wheatbeltnrm.org.au">jlucas@wheatbeltnrm.org.au</a>                 | 0499 389 134                   |
| Aimee Ray         | Avon River Basin             | <a href="mailto:aray@wheatbeltnrm.org.au">aray@wheatbeltnrm.org.au</a>                     | 0420 363 052                   |
| David Broadhurst  | Swan                         | <a href="mailto:david.broadhurst@perthnrm.com">david.broadhurst@perthnrm.com</a>           | (08) 9374 3306                 |
| Tam Kempton       | Swan                         | <a href="mailto:Tamagen.kempton@perthnrm.com">Tamagen.kempton@perthnrm.com</a>             | 0438 933 697                   |
| Amelia Thorton    | South West                   | <a href="mailto:athornton@southwestnrm.org.au">athornton@southwestnrm.org.au</a>           | 0427 806 193<br>(08) 9938 0117 |
| Yvette Hollings   | Northern Agricultural Region | <a href="mailto:yvette.hollings@nacc.com.au">yvette.hollings@nacc.com.au</a>               | 0447 298 063                   |
| Sam Burges        | Rangelands                   | <a href="mailto:samb@rangelandswa.com.au">samb@rangelandswa.com.au</a>                     | 0427 626 222                   |
| Suzannah Macbeth  | South Coast                  | <a href="mailto:suzannahm@southcoastnrm.com.au">suzannahm@southcoastnrm.com.au</a>         | (08) 9845 8537                 |
| Georgina Warden   | Peel-Harvey                  | <a href="mailto:georgina.warden@peel-harvey.org.au">georgina.warden@peel-harvey.org.au</a> | 0448 530 044                   |

## Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitators (RALFs)

RALFs were funded by the department under the previous five-year phase of the NHT, as part of the \$450 million Regional Land Partnerships program (2017-18 to 2022-23). This program concluded on 30 June 2023.

The RALF component of the program was allocated over \$33 million, nationally, over the five-year period.

RALFs supported farmers, industry and community groups (including Landcare Groups) to adopt new and innovative sustainable agriculture practices. Establishing and building partnerships with these key groups was also central to the RALF role.

This video provides a short overview of the RALF role.

Emily Hinds, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Northern Territory

A lot of people do not know; the RALF is the Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator

Evizel Seymour, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Wet Tropics QLD

The RALF role to me is about networking with people, engaging and bringing them together so they can learn

Emily Hinds, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Northern Territory

Getting them to understand some practices, learn from each other, provide them with some knowledge, training and try to find out what they need.\

Evizel Seymour, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Wet Tropics QLD

Really engage with them and build their capacity

Emily Hinds, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Northern Territory

We have got growers in a whole lot of different commodities. But we have also got training, knowledge symposiums and engagement activities

Evizel Seymour, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Wet Tropics QLD

Helping them with grants, grant writing and running grants

Emily Hinds, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Northern Territory

The RALF role is the conduit for the agricultural community. We will get everyone together on the same page and they will learn different techniques from each other

Kellie Evans, Grazier, Atherton Tablelands QLD

The RALF role in my community is basically that social networking and I have gained so much knowledge from all different aspects that I can put back into my field

Evizel Seymour, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Wet Tropics QLD

It is really engaging with people, supporting them and being there for them. It has been great working with people like Kellie and just seeing the growth, the capacity, and the love for learning

Kellie Evans, Grazier, Atherton Tablelands QLD

I had questions about trying to learn a little bit more about sustainability and soil health. Straight away she had three or four options. She had phone numbers and contacts of people she knew could answer the questions

Liza Maeasigan-Nguyen, Dragon fruit farmer, Northern Territory.

We see that we can work with the RALF when it comes to soil health and sustainability, because we know that there is a lot of things we need to learn

Emily Hinds, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Northern Territory

Everyone is keen to do the right thing in their area but they're not necessarily aware of how to do it, that's where we can draw on people's knowledge from interstate and the RALF network itself

Mark Savina, Sugarcane farmer, Wet Tropics QLD

Mark: I have struck up a good relationship with them and a working relationship. I have got numbers in my phone that I know I can ring and say "Look, I've got a problem, who do I go to see?". Because of their experience in the industry and that is what we need

Emily Hinds, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Northern Territory

I hope that this publication can really showcase what the RALF role is all about for the people in the region, for the farmers and pastoralists.

Vuong Nguyen, Dragon fruit farmer, Northern Territory

I am happy that I'm included, I feel involved with the RALF

Evizel Seymour, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Wet Tropics QLD

I would love to see the publication for the RALF role engage people and make them understand what a RALF does

Emily Hinds, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Northern Territory

It is a non-commercial, non-biased, not trying to sell anything, independent advice on sustainable agriculture.

Vuong Nguyen, Dragon fruit farmer, Northern Territory

I think it has opened to Darwin and Australia. It opened to many people that care about their land and what they do

Mark Savina, Sugarcane farmer, Wet Tropics QLD

We need that person to coordinate help for us all the way along

Kellie Evans, Grazier, Atherton Tablelands QLD

Her phone number is on speed dial, it is in my favourites section of my phone. She is the first person I call

Evizel Seymour, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Wet Tropics QLD

I love the RALF role because I am a people person

Emily Hinds, Regional Agriculture Landcare Facilitator (RALF), Northern Territory

When you get to meet these people face to face and create real relationships and friendships.

Vuong Nguyen, Dragon fruit farmer, Northern Territory

It is a thumbs up for everyone

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/farm-food-drought/natural-resources/landcare/climate-smart/sustainable-agriculture-facilitators>